

Shedir
540 Suns

Epsilon Cassiopeiae
630 Suns

Gamma Cassiopeiae
3,400 Suns

In November 1572, a
supernova in Cassiopeia
was as bright as the planet
Venus and visible by day

KEY DATA

Size ranking 25

Brightest stars Shedir (α)
2.2, Gamma (γ) 2.2

Genitive Cassiopeiae

Abbreviation Cas

Highest in sky at 10pm
October–December

Fully visible 90°N–12°S



CHART 1

MAIN STARS

Shedir Alpha (α) Cassiopeiae
Orange giant; Schedar is an alternative spelling

☼ 2.2 ↔ 230 light-years

Caph Beta (β) Cassiopeiae
White giant

☼ 2.3 ↔ 55 light-years

Gamma (γ) Cassiopeiae
Blue-white subgiant

☼ 2.4 ↔ 550 light-years

Ruchbah Delta (δ) Cassiopeiae
White subgiant

☼ 2.7 ↔ 99 light-years

Epsilon (ϵ) Cassiopeiae
Blue giant

☼ 3.4 ↔ 410 light-years

Eta (η) Cassiopeiae
Yellow main-sequence star

☼ 3.4 ↔ 19 light-years

Rho (ρ) Cassiopeiae
Yellow supergiant variable

☼ 4.1–6.2 ↔ 12,000 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

M52
Bright open cluster of about 100 stars

M103
Small open cluster of about 25 stars

NGC 457
Loose open cluster of about 80 stars

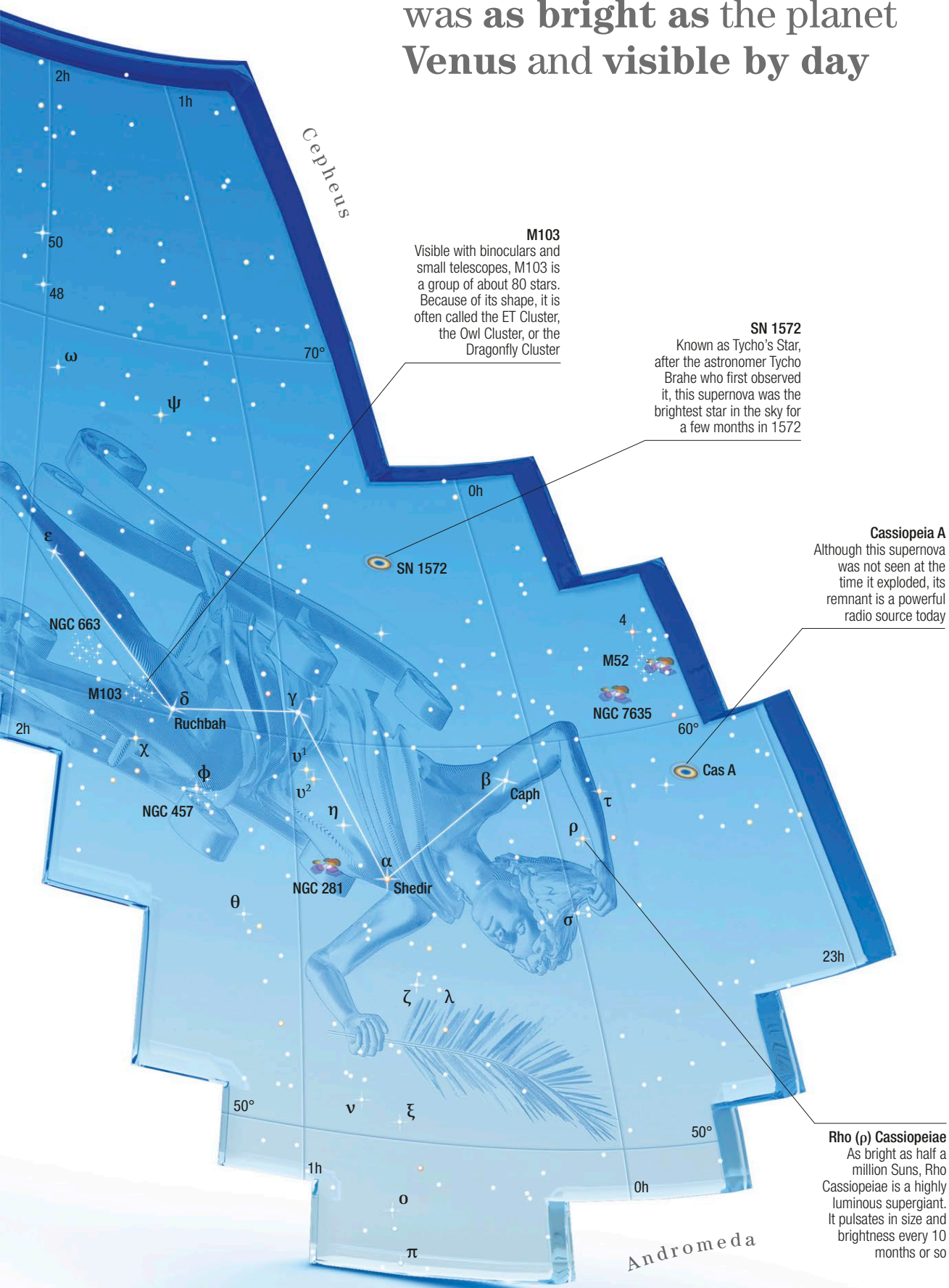
NGC 663
Large open cluster of about 80 stars

NGC 7635
Emission nebula; also known as the Bubble Nebula

IC 1805
Star cluster surrounded by the Heart Nebula

Cassiopeia A
Supernova remnant; strong radio source

SN 1572
Supernova remnant



Cassiopeia A
Although this supernova was not seen at the time it exploded, its remnant is a powerful radio source today

Rho (ρ) Cassiopeiae
As bright as half a million Suns, Rho Cassiopeiae is a highly luminous supergiant. It pulsates in size and brightness every 10 months or so

M103
Visible with binoculars and small telescopes, M103 is a group of about 80 stars. Because of its shape, it is often called the ET Cluster, the Owl Cluster, or the Dragonfly Cluster

SN 1572
Known as Tycho's Star, after the astronomer Tycho Brahe who first observed it, this supernova was the brightest star in the sky for a few months in 1572